higher education & training

Department:
Higher Education and Training
REPUBLIC OF SOUTH AFRICA

NATIONAL CERTIFICATE (VOCATIONAL)

OFFICE PRACTICE
NQF LEVEL 2

(3061012)

20 November 2019 (Y-Paper)
09:00–12:00

This question paper consists of 13 pages and 3 addenda.

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TIME: 2½ HOURS
MARKS: 150

INSTRUCTIONS AND INFORMATION

1. Read ALL the questions carefully.
2. Answer ALL the questions.
3. Number the answers according to the numbering system used in this question paper.
4. Start each question on a NEW page.
5. Write neatly and legibly.

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SECTION A

QUESTION 1

1.1 Various options are given as possible answers to the following questions. Choose the answer and write only the letter (A–D) next to the question number (1.1.1–1.1.10) in the ANSWER BOOK.

1.1.1 This guides customers through the company premises and warns them of any safety hazards:

A Permit
B Map
C Signage
D Intercom

1.1.2 A document that accompanies goods sent by courier to provide detailed information about the delivery and allows it to be tracked:

A Passport
B Invoice
C Waybill
D Statement

1.1.3 … is done to ensure that space becomes available in the active filing systems and prime storage space is not wasted by outdated correspondence.

A Filing
B Archiving
C Faxing
D Cross-referencing

1.1.4 If a charity worker visits the reception of an organisation to request a donation towards their cause, this would be an example of a/an … enquiry.

A unpredictable
B predictable
C expected
D anticipated

1.1.5 An acceptable statement when placing a caller on hold:

A Hang on a minute.
B Would you mind holding the line?
C Wait a second.
D You will have to wait a while.

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1.1.6 A type of language consisting of words and phrases that are regarded as very informal:

A Jargon
B Dialect
C Gossip
D Slang

1.1.7 Complete a/an … register to keep track of all money received in incoming mail.

A allowance
B settlement
C remittance
D dispatch

1.1.8 … incoming mail to identify when it was received.

A Certify
B Postmark
C Photocopy
D Date stamp

1.1.9 A positive or close relationship between people that often involves mutual trust, understanding and attention.

A Rapport
B Empathy
C Attraction
D Kindness

1.1.10 If you receive a suspicious-looking letter or package, you should …

A notify security.
B throw it into the waste bin.
C remove the content.
D deliver it to the recipient.

(10 × 1) (10)

1.2 Choose an item from COLUMN B that matches a description in COLUMN A. Write only the letter (A–J) next to the question number (1.2.1–1.2.10) in the ANSWER BOOK.

COLUMN A		COLUMN B	
1.2.1	A document that is obtained from a supplier to find out the price of a product or service	A	telephone directory
1.2.2	Displayed in the reception area and contains pictures and information about the organisation's products/services	B	negligence
1.2.3	You can't hear what the caller is saying because of a weak cellphone signal	C	records
1.2.4	Repeat back to the customer until you know what is really bothering him or her	D	quotation
1.2.5	A comprehensive list of residential and business contact details	E	personal
1.2.6	Source documents that give transaction dates and amounts, legal agreements, customer information and business details	F	switchboard
1.2.7	Information that can only be opened and read by the intended person	G	brochure
1.2.8	Not taking the responsibility of safeguarding confidential information seriously	H	body language
1.2.9	Equipment used for the manual control of telephone connections in an office, hotel, or other large building	I	physical interference
1.2.10	The gestures, movements, and mannerisms by which a person communicates with others	J	reflecting

(10 × 1) (10)

1.3 Indicate whether the following statements are TRUE or FALSE. Choose the answer and write only 'True' or 'False' next to the question number (1.3.1–1.3.10) in the ANSWER BOOK.

1.3.1 The reception is an ideal place to display awards the organisation has won as well as photos of management.

1.3.2 It is not necessary to complete the file movement register if your supervisor requests to borrow a file.

1.3.3 Non-routine problems of office equipment do not require any special technical skills because they are easy to fix.

1.3.4 When you answer a business call, you may have to ask probing questions to determine what the call is about.

1.3.5 Office equipment should not be placed under a window in direct sunlight.

1.3.6 It is important that the mailroom clerk should follow company procedure when receiving, sorting and dispatching mail.

1.3.7 A mailroom clerk can improve on their work performance by taking longer lunch breaks.

1.3.8 Think through exactly what you plan to say before you place a call.

1.3.9 Only staff in the marketing department needs to have knowledge of the organisation's products and/or services.

1.3.10 Make sure backup copies of computerised records are stored in a separate location to your business in case of fire, theft or a natural disaster.

(10 × 1) (10)
[30]

TOTAL SECTION A: 30

SECTION B

Read the scenario below. The scenario forms the basis of Section B.

Quali-Furn is a furniture manufacturing company in South Africa. They specialise in high-quality wooden furniture, including bedroom, lounge and dining room sets. Quali-Furn operates from a large facility which includes an administration building, showroom and production plant. You are the receptionist for this busy organisation. Your duties include welcoming visitors by greeting them, in person or on the telephone; answering or referring inquiries; directing visitors; maintaining security by following procedures; monitoring the logbook; and issuing visitor badges.

QUESTION 2

2.1 It is company policy that all visitors must sign the visitors register and be issued with a visitor's card. At 08:50 this morning Mr Hugo, from Speedy Repairs, arrives at reception. He has an appointment with the Production Manager, Mr Davids. Mr Hugo has come to repair the table saw in the factory. Mr Hugo's cellphone number is 0712233445. You issued him with visitor card number 0055.

Complete the visitor's register on behalf of Mr Hugo. Write only the answers next to the numbers (2.1.1–2.1.8) in the ANSWER BOOK.

Visitor Card No.	Date & Time	Name of visitor	Company	Person Visiting	Depart-ment	Reason for visiting	Contact number
2.1.1	2.1.2	2.1.3	2.1.4	2.1.5	2.1.6	2.1.7	2.1.8

(8 × 1) (8)

2.2 Quali-Furn staff interacting with customers is required to dress neatly and professionally.

Study the images below and identify which item is SUITABLE or NOT SUITABLE office wear. Choose the answer and write only 'Suitable' or 'Not suitable' next to the question number (2.2.1–2.2.6) in the ANSWER BOOK.

2.2.1



2.2.2



2.2.3



2.2.4



2.2.5



2.2.6



(6 × 1) (6)

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2.3 What negative impact does it have on Quali-Furn if the receptionist supplies inaccurate information to customers? (2 × 1) (2)

2.4 Quali-Furn keeps all their important documents in a safe place. Only authorised staff is allowed access to these company documents.

2.4.1 Explain why confidential information is only given to people who have been authorised to have access to it. (2)

2.4.2 Give FOUR examples of information that would be considered confidential. (4)

2.4.3 What are the implications of not being able to locate a file? (3)

2.5 A junior clerk at Quali-Furn recorded the following telephone message. Using your knowledge of how to correctly record telephone messages, identify all the mistakes he made.

Quali-Furn Telephone Message	
To: *Zizi*	Date: *Monday*
From: *Mr Frans*	Time: *8*
Company: *IBE*	Phone number: *0847788789*
Message: *Phone him back*	
Message taken by: *Jono*	

(5)
[30]

QUESTION 3

3.1 A clean reception ensures the health and safety of employees and visitors. At times, maintenance may also need to be done. Identify whether the following are HOUSEKEEPING or MAINTENANCE tasks.

Choose the answer and write 'Housekeeping' or 'Maintenance' next to the question number (3.1.1–3.1.6) in the ANSWER BOOK.

3.1.1 Faulty air conditioner

3.1.2 A spilt cup of coffee

3.1.3 Torn magazines

3.1.4 Overflowing wastepaper basket

3.1.5 A fused light bulb

3.1.6 A cracked window pane

(6 × 1) (6)

3.2 Explain why it is important to always be friendly, polite and professional towards customers. (2 × 2) (4)

3.3 While e-mail and postal communication may be efficient, the telephone is still an ideal way to contact customers. Phone calls allow you and your customers to save time by giving them the answers they need in real time.

3.3.1 Explain the difference between answering your personal phone and answering a business call. (2)

3.3.2 Before making telephone calls, you will need to find telephone numbers of different companies and people you need to call.

How would you go about finding these telephone numbers? (4 × 1) (4)

3.4 You received the following e-mail from a customer this morning:

TO: admin@qualifurn.co.za
FROM: gbaker@gmail.com

Four weeks ago, I placed an online order for the Deluxe dining room table and chair set. Your website states that goods should be delivered within 5 to 7 days of the order. NO ONE in your organisation can tell me why this is taking so long. To make matters worse, your sales manager, Peter Max, is not returning my calls!

I trust that this matter will be resolved as soon as possible!

From
Gary Baker
Cell: 0655443322

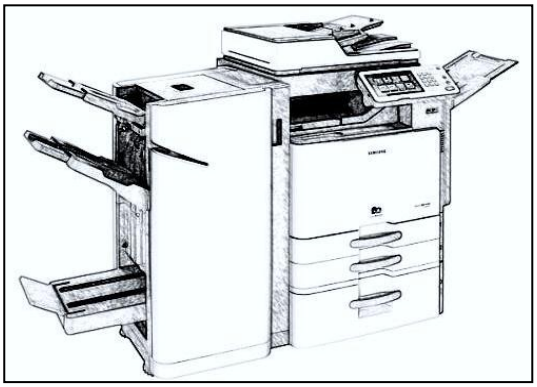
3.4.1 Record this complaint on the customer complaint log (ADDENDUM A). (10)

3.4.2 How would you go about solving this complaint? (2 × 2) (4)

[30]

QUESTION 4

4.1 The following machine can be found in the administration office of Quali-Furn:



4.1.1 Identify this machine. (2)

4.1.2 Give TWO functions of this machine. (2)

4.1.3 Give FOUR guidelines on how to clean electronic office equipment. (4)

4.1.4 When ordering consumables, it is company policy to submit a requisition form. Complete a requisition form (ADDENDUM B) for 10 boxes of A4 printing paper on behalf of the administration office. Your supervisor, Mrs Njani, will authorise the order. (5)

4.2 ALL telephone calls at Quali-Furn should be handled with discretion and confidentiality.

Explain what you would do in each of the following situations:

4.2.1 A caller wants to know the home telephone number of the manager of the organisation.

4.2.2 A caller makes an enquiry about when he can expect his order to be delivered.

4.2.3 A caller asks how much tax your organisation paid to SARS last year.

4.2.4 A caller claims that he has paid his account in full but received an invoice saying he still owes R1 000.

4.2.5 A caller enquires about the organisation's job vacancies.

(5 × 2) (10)

4.3 What should you do with post that has been incorrectly delivered to your organisation? (1 × 2) (2)

4.4 Quali-Furn offers store credit to customers. The customer may purchase a product and pay it off over 12 months. This is an example of a credit application form:

QUALI-FURN CUSTOMER CREDIT APPLICATION FORM			
Surname:	*Brown*	Name:	*James*
ID number:	*7801050000001*	Work telephone:	*0127070700*
Employer:	*Department of Education*	Home telephone:	*0127006006*
Work address:	*10 Struben Street, Pretoria, 0001*	Cellphone:	*0713456789*
Home address:	*105 Ruby Road, Pretoria, 0001*	Bank:	*ABC Bank*
Monthly income:	*R25 000.00*	Account no:	*1015656*
The applicant will be bound to any or all amount/s due to Quali-Furn at any stage of this credit agreement.			
Sign	*J Brown*	Date	*30 July 2018*

4.4.1 Why is it necessary that the customer gives Quali-Furn their personal information when applying for credit? (2)

4.4.2 If Mr Brown changes his address and/or cellphone number and doesn't inform Quali-Furn, what are the implications of this for the business? (2)

4.4.3 Which department at Quali-Furn would keep this document in a safe place once completed and approved? (1)

[30]

QUESTION 5

5.1 Write down in in the ANSWER BOOK, next to the question number (5.1.1–5.1.2), a possible consequence due to the following reasons for delays in distribution of mail.

Reason for delay in distribution of mail	**Consequence**
A confidential report is accidentally delivered to the wrong staff member who doesn't realise the error until he opens the envelope and sees it isn't addressed to him.	5.1.1
The mail room key is missing. It takes two hours to find the spare key.	5.1.2

(2 × 2) (4)

5.2 The following parcels must be dispatched to customers of Quali-Furn. Calculate the total cost of postage for ALL the parcels. Write only the total cost next to the question number (5.2.1–5.2.3) in the ANSWER BOOK.

The South African Post Office charges the following rate:

Counter to counter	**R50.00** for the first kilogram **R15.00** for each additional kg or part of a kg

Parcel weight	Total cost of postage
8 kg	5.2.1
4 kg	5.2.2
2,5 kg	5.2.3

(2 × 3) (6)

5.3 In an effective filing system, documents are organised in a logical way and staff using the files are able to find what they are looking for quickly and easily.

5.3.1 Arrange the following files in ascending date order.

2017/04/14
2018/09/17
2017/01/15
2018/09/19
2018/08/17 (5)

5.3.2 Arrange the following account numbers in descending order.

QF0540
QF0556
QF0536
QF0554
QF0544 (5)

5.4 You have been instructed to distribute the new leave policy to all departments. In order for you to have evidence that all managers have received the policy, you attach a routing slip. The leave policy was distributed to the following managers today:

1. Mr L. Alba, Production Manager, Room F3, Factory
2. Ms G. Merkle, Finance Manager, Room A22, Admin centre

Complete the mail routing slip (ADDENDUM C), using the information provided above. (10)
[30]

TOTAL SECTION B: 120
GRAND TOTAL: 150

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ADDENDUM A **EXAMINATION NUMBER:**

QUESTION 3.4.1

CUSTOMER COMPLAINT LOG						
Date of complaint:		How was complaint received? *(mark with an x)*	Phone	E-mail	Walk-in	Social media
Name of customer:		Contact details of customer:				
Nature of enquiry:						
Person responsible for solving complaint:						
Enquiry received by:						

ADDENDUM B **EXAMINATION NUMBER:**

QUESTION 4.1.4

REQUISITION FORM	
Department:	
Date:	
QUANTITY	**ITEM DESCRIPTION**
Authorised by:	

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ADDENDUM C **EXAMINATION NUMBER:**

QUESTION 5.4

MAIL ROUTING SLIP				
Document distributed:				
Distribution date:				
Routing sequence	**Staff member**	**Job title**	**Room number & Building**	**Initials**
1				
2				

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